

Building line – The position of the property from the site boundary.

Building restrictions – Planning and development controls that limit the use, size and location of buildings.

Buyers' agent, or advocate – Represents a buyer in negotiations with a vendor; the agent is paid privately by the buyer.

Buyers' market – This situation refers to when, under competitive conditions, the pressures of supply and demand are such that the buyer has an advantage over the seller.

Capital gain – The amount by which the proceeds of the resale of a property are more than its original cost.

Capital gains tax – A tax paid on the capital gain made on the sale of an investment property.

Caveat – A notice on a title that states another party, other than the owner, has a legal and financial interest in it. A caveat can be applied to a home's title after a deposit is paid, to protect the buyer before they settle on the property.

Caveat emptor – Latin phrase, meaning 'buyer beware'; the risk in a property transaction lies with the purchaser.

Certificate of title – A document issued to show ownership.

Commission – The fee or payment that a vendor makes to a real estate agent for their work and services.

Common property – In the context of a unit or a development, this refers to parts of the property owned and used by all owners or occupiers, which are maintained by the body corporate.

Compound interest – Interest calculated on a sum that includes previous interest payments.

Cooling-off period – A short statutory period during which the purchaser may cancel the contract.